

Utrains Company Handbook

Approved policy collection | Edition 2026.1 | Status: Current

Purpose and authority

This handbook describes workplace policies, responsibilities, procedures, exceptions, and escalation paths. The current policy repository is authoritative when a policy or plan changes. Each section includes an owner, version, status, and review context so an information system can return traceable evidence instead of an unsupported guess.

Field	Value
Edition	2026.1
Status	Current
Owner	People Operations
Review cycle	Annual or after a material change

1. Time Off and Annual Leave

Scope and policy

Full-time employees receive 20 days of annual leave each calendar year. Requests should normally be submitted through the HR portal at least five business days before the first day away. Managers should respond within two business days.

Procedure and responsibilities

The employee checks the available balance, submits the requested dates, and waits for manager approval before booking travel. The HR Leave Team handles urgent, protected, or medically related leave through a separate confidential process.

Examples and operational notes

Employees should use the approved portal or channel for this policy and retain any required approval. The policy owner is responsible for current guidance, while managers apply the process consistently. Questions that require a decision, private records, or an exception must be routed to the named human owner. This section is version 2026.1, status current, source [company_handbook.pdf](#), section 1.

2. Company Holidays

Scope and policy

The company observes ten paid holidays for United States employees. Employees in other regions follow the local calendar published in the HR portal. The published calendar is the authoritative schedule for the current policy year.

Procedure and responsibilities

Employees scheduled to work on a holiday must receive the applicable premium or replacement day under local law. A manager may not replace a statutory holiday without consulting HR and local counsel.

Examples and operational notes

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3. Parental Leave

Scope and policy

Full-time employees become eligible for paid parental leave after six months of continuous service. Eligible employees may receive 20 weeks for birth, adoption, or placement of a child. The Leave Team confirms eligibility before approval.

Procedure and responsibilities

Employees should notify the Leave Team as early as possible. Company leave may run concurrently with statutory leave where permitted. The assistant can explain the process but cannot determine a medical or legal entitlement.

Examples and operational notes

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4. Caregiver and Medical Leave

Scope and policy

Employees who need medical or caregiver leave should contact the Leave Team through the secure leave channel. Managers must not request a diagnosis or store medical information in ordinary team documents.

Procedure and responsibilities

The Leave Team provides the required forms and confirms the schedule. The employee's health provider supplies medical certification when required. Clinical decisions belong to qualified providers, not to HR staff or an assistant.

Examples and operational notes

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5. Health Benefits

Scope and policy

Employees may choose individual or family coverage during the enrollment window. For the 2026 plan year, HMO-204 has a \$35 specialist copay and PPO-440 has a \$60 specialist copay. Current premiums, deductibles, and network details are published in the benefits portal.

Procedure and responsibilities

The benefits portal controls current prices because plans can change during the year. An employee should verify the plan year before relying on an answer. The Benefits Team handles enrollment corrections and qualifying life events.

Examples and operational notes

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6. Retirement Savings

Scope and policy

Eligible employees may contribute through payroll deductions. The company matches 50 percent of employee contributions up to six percent of eligible pay, subject to the plan document and local requirements.

Procedure and responsibilities

Employees change contributions through the payroll system. The plan administrator determines eligibility, vesting, investment options, and final account information. HR can explain the process but does not provide investment advice.

Examples and operational notes

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7. Travel and Expense Reimbursement

Scope and policy

Standard rail travel below USD 250 per trip does not require prior approval. Air travel, international travel, and any trip above USD 250 require manager approval before booking. Receipts must be submitted through the expense portal within 30 days.

Procedure and responsibilities

Personal upgrades are not reimbursable unless approved as an accessibility accommodation. A missing receipt requires a written explanation and Finance review. The expense policy owner may reject costs that lack business purpose or required approval.

Examples and operational notes

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8. Remote and Hybrid Work

Scope and policy

Eligible roles may use a hybrid schedule recorded in the team workspace. Managers may require attendance for customer events, training, or operational needs. Working from another country requires Legal, Tax, and Security approval before travel.

Procedure and responsibilities

Remote work does not change working-hour, confidentiality, equipment, or security obligations. An arrangement can be reviewed when business needs or performance expectations change. HR records the approved arrangement.

Examples and operational notes

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9. Compensation Reviews

Scope and policy

The annual compensation cycle begins in October and is completed by March. Employees may request a compensation review through their manager or the confidential HR channel. A request should describe role scope, outcomes, and relevant market information.

Procedure and responsibilities

A request starts a review and does not guarantee an adjustment. Compensation decisions require budget, market, performance, and equity review. HR communicates the outcome through the approved channel and records the decision.

Examples and operational notes

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10. Performance Management

Scope and policy

Managers set goals at the beginning of the performance year and provide feedback throughout the year. Employees may request a feedback conversation at any time. Formal documentation belongs in the approved HR system.

Procedure and responsibilities

If an employee believes the process was not followed, they may ask HR to facilitate a review. Retaliation for raising a good-faith concern is prohibited. The assistant should route sensitive disputes to HR rather than making a judgment.

Examples and operational notes

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11. Recruiting and Internal Mobility

Scope and policy

Open roles are posted in the internal careers portal. Employees may apply when they meet the published requirements and have discussed the move with their manager. Interview information is confidential and must be stored in the applicant tracking system.

Procedure and responsibilities

Hiring teams follow fair hiring procedures and document decisions. A manager cannot block an application in retaliation for a good-faith career discussion. Recruiting owns the current application requirements.

Examples and operational notes

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12. Onboarding

Scope and policy

New employees complete identity verification, employment forms, security training, and equipment setup during their first week. The hiring manager owns the onboarding checklist and HR owns employment records.

Procedure and responsibilities

Access to production systems requires completed training and manager approval. A delayed background check or missing form may delay access. The assistant can explain the checklist and route missing-access requests to the onboarding owner.

Examples and operational notes

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13. Information Security

Scope and policy

Employees must use company-managed devices and approved identity controls. Passwords, tokens, and recovery codes must never be shared. Suspected phishing, lost devices, or accidental disclosure must be reported through the security incident channel.

Procedure and responsibilities

Security incidents are urgent and should not wait for a routine HR response. The Security Team determines containment and notification steps. The assistant must never reveal private incident details to an unauthorized requester.

Examples and operational notes

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14. Acceptable Use

Scope and policy

Company systems support work and limited personal use that does not create risk, cost, or disruption. Employees may not install unapproved software, bypass security controls, or upload company data to an unapproved service.

Procedure and responsibilities

Security may block tools that process regulated or customer data. Exceptions require a documented business need, risk review, and an expiry date. The employee remains responsible for protecting data while an exception is active.

Examples and operational notes

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15. Workplace Conduct

Scope and policy

The company expects respectful, inclusive, and professional conduct. Harassment, discrimination, retaliation, and threats are prohibited. Concerns may be reported to a manager, HR, Ethics, or the confidential reporting channel.

Procedure and responsibilities

Reports are handled according to the investigation process and applicable law. The assistant may explain available reporting paths but must not investigate, identify an accused person, or promise an outcome.

Examples and operational notes

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16. Conflicts of Interest

Scope and policy

Employees must disclose outside work, gifts, investments, or relationships that could affect business decisions. Compliance reviews disclosures and records approved mitigation.

Procedure and responsibilities

When in doubt, disclose the situation before accepting an assignment or gift. A manager may not approve a conflict alone when Legal or Compliance review is required. The record includes the decision owner and expiration date.

Examples and operational notes

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17. Data Privacy

Scope and policy

Personal information must be collected, accessed, and retained only for an approved business purpose. Employees should use the minimum necessary data and follow retention schedules.

Procedure and responsibilities

Privacy questions go to the Privacy Team. The HR assistant must not expose private records in a chat response. Access scope is part of authorization and is separate from retrieving a semantically similar document.

Examples and operational notes

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18. Policy Ownership and Versions

Scope and policy

Each policy has an owner, effective date, review date, and status. The current policy repository is authoritative. Archived policies remain available for audit but should not guide current employee decisions.

Procedure and responsibilities

The owner approves changes and publishes a new version. Retrieval systems must preserve version and status metadata so archived text can be excluded. A policy answer should cite the version used.

Examples and operational notes

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19. Exceptions and Escalation

Scope and policy

An exception requires an approved owner, a business reason, a scope, and an expiration date. Employees should use the escalation path named in the policy rather than asking an assistant to approve an exception.

Procedure and responsibilities

The assistant may explain the process and create an authorized follow-up request. A human owner makes the decision. Expired exceptions must not be returned as current policy guidance.

Examples and operational notes

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20. HR Service Levels

Scope and policy

Routine policy questions received through the HR mailbox may take up to 24 hours for a first response. The proposed RAG assistant is intended to provide a first grounded answer in seconds, twenty-four hours a day, while routing sensitive or unresolved cases to HR.

Procedure and responsibilities

The assistant must cite evidence, state when evidence is insufficient, and preserve human escalation. Service metrics include response time, grounded-answer rate, unanswered questions, escalation volume, and user feedback.

Examples and operational notes

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